

	Environmental Analysis Teaching and Research Laboratory	Date: 6/16/2025	SOP No. X
	Standard Operating Procedure	Title: Nitrate and Ammonium	
	Approved By: Los Huertos	Revised: July 3, 2025	

1. Scope and Application

2. Health and Safety

3. Personnel & Training Responsibilities

Students using this SOP should be trained for the following SOPsa:

- SOP1
- SOP2

4. Required Materials

4.1 Reciprocating shaker

4.2 Graduated cylinder or volumetric flask repipet type dispenser

4.3 Filter funnels

4.4 Whatman 42 filter paper

4.5 Paper bags or aluminum weigh boats

4.6 Specimen containers or Nalgene bottles

4.7 Test tubes

4.8 Pipet

4.9 Top-loading balance

5. Creating KCL solution

5.1 Weigh out 298.2 g KCL into a 2L volumetric flask

5.2 Fill volumetric flask with distilled water until approximately 2/3rds full

5.3 Place volumetric flask on magnetic stirrer and place a magnetic stir bar into the volumetric flask

5.4 Turn magnetic stirrer onto a low to medium level, and leave on for 4 hours

Table 1: Soil Texture Correction Factor

Texture	Moist Soil	Dry Soil
Sand	2.3	2.6
Loam	2.0	2.5
Clay	1.7	2.2

5.5 Use stir bar retriever to remove magnetic stir bar

5.6 Fill the volumetric flask up to the 2L mark with distilled water

Lab Procedure

5.7 Fill test tubes with 40 ml of KCL solution

5.8 Add 10g of soil into container until solution reaches 50 ml

5.9 Cap and place on reciprocating shaker for for 2 hours

5.10 Allow sample to sit and soil particles to settle (around 10 mins, no more than 1hr)

5.11 Place filter paper inside funnels, and set up funnels to drain into labeled containers

5.12 Pour shaken solution into into funnels, don't fill funnels above filter paper line

5.13 Allow solution to drain into new container until only soil (no liquid) remains in original container

5.14 Filtered solution is now ready to be analyzed. Cap containers and store in a cold location. If analysis will not be completed in the next few days, store the samples in the freezer until analysis.

5.15 Corrected value = test strip value of N (ppm) / correction factor

5.16 record nitrate ppm and correction factor in field notebook

6. References

6.1 APHA, AWWA. WEF. (2012) Standard Methods for examination of water and wastewater. 22nd American Public Health Association (Eds.). Washington. 1360 pp. (2014).